Part 1 Summary

This section examines how 50 major companies communicated their beliefs and values from 2016 to 2024. The companies represent five S&P 500 sectors: Technology, Financials, Healthcare, Consumer Discretionary, and Energy. The motive is to identify the values emphasized in public statements and assess the major themes and how the themes have evolved over time.

Data Collection: I used Wayback Machine CDX API to retrieve the historical versions of each company's "About Us" page, by taking the archived snapshot closest to July 1, this was designed in a way that the page stood mid-year. The median snapshot falls within seven days of this date. Out of the total 450 possible company-year observations, 334 were retrieved and 299 contained enough text for analysis. Of the 116 missing years, 103 had no archived capture at all, and the rest had no page at that address or could not be downloaded. Every missing observation was kept in the final dataset to show consistency.

LLM Analysis: After removing navigation menus, footers, and other irrelevant page content, I used Google Gemini's language model to classify each page into ten themes: integrity, innovation, customer focus, collaboration, diversity and inclusion, performance, adaptability, community, safety and sustainability. Gemini also compared each company's page across years and described how the wording changed.

Through this, I noticed that companies lead with innovation (70% of pages) and customer focus (65%). I further realized that the rarest theme is Adaptability (18%), suggesting companies focus on their core values. I felt it made sense to compare each sector independent to each other, as they have different focuses.

Sector	Most Distinctive Themes
Technology	Innovation: 83%, Diversity and Inclusion: 52%
Financials	Integrity: 61%, Performance: 70%
HealthCare	Innovation: 91%, Customer Focus: 87%
Consumer Discretionary	Customers: 75%, Community: 63%
Energy	Sustainability: 78%, Safety: 67%

Interpreting the Results: As I compared the years, I noticed that the portrayal of values shifted after 2020, with diversity and inclusion increasing from 34% to 45% of pages and safety from 24% to 38%. As these are large firms, they are a meaningful record of how companies want to be seen, but also notice that its depends on the sector, technology and healthcare focus more on innovation , while energy focuses more on sustainability.

The main limitation is incomplete due to the lost data in the earlier years, so trends before 2020 are less available. This analysis measured only the stated corporate values, and not the actual organizational practices. Despite these limitations, it gives a clear understanding of the stated values compared with each as forms of indicators of organizational culture.